

MIGHTIER THAN THE SWORD

BASIC RULES / 2-4 PLAYERS / THREE ACTS

SETUP

Shuffle 9 books; start with 3 in a triangle: two side by side, one centered below. Stack the rest face down. Books use a hexagonal grid; each has 2 pages. A touching page edge or internal fold costs 1 move. Each player takes a protagonist, 12 Inklings and 12 memories (3 per row). Start at 0 points, with 6 supply Inklings, 3 reserved for Act II, 3 for Act III; cover every upgrade with a memory. Shuffle decks; deal 1 Twist and 1 hidden Subplot each. No starting characters. Place protagonists on any pages. From the base pool of 15 conflict tokens (5 per Act), randomly select 1 per player for EACH Act; set the rest aside. Display Act I's tokens. Choose a first player; turns go clockwise.

YOUR TURN

With no supply Inklings at the start, shoot the moon (below). Otherwise move your protagonist at least 1 page, up to your movement limit, ending on a different page from its starting page. Then choose ONE action: place Inklings on its page using Resolve; replace one of your Inklings there with a memory; OR place 1 supply Inking on a character's empty activation square and use its action. Characters move only through abilities and carry nothing. Twists are played ONLY in conflict. Resolve immediate conflicts before continuing any remaining placements. Finish effects, then discard to your combined hand limit (Twists plus your active Subplot) and end your turn.

Inklings AND PLACEMENT

Use empty numbered spaces on your active page; if full, use shared overflow. Numbered spaces have no automatic Twist reward. Gain any memory rewards and on-placement book effects, including on bonus placements. Moving an Inking grants no placement rewards. Erase returns it to its owner's supply; suspend sends it to their NEXT Act reserve (out of play in Act III). Foreshadow moves Inklings from next reserve to supply; gain 1 point each if unavailable. Gain a character by drawing the top card onto your protagonist's page unless stated otherwise; empty deck gives 2 points. Figures fill no spaces, except Agamemnon's trigger exception. Characters move between adjacent pages unless stated otherwise.

MEMORIES AND UPGRADES

Suspend your Inking from a numbered space without a memory; replace it with the leftmost covered memory from any row, improving that row. The space becomes empty. Memories add no power, never fill spaces and grant no Twist check. An Inking may later occupy a memory space; it counts normally. Its owner and the memory owner each gain that memory's benefit (once if the same player), in that order. Curiosity places its bonus Inking in this book's overflow. Returning a memory lowers its row; an Inking on it stays. Extra upgrades still suspend Inklings; if impossible, gain 2 points.

SUBPLOTS

Keep your Subplot hidden in your hand. Objectives check the current board and tracks; no counters or recorded progress are used. All stated requirements must be true together. Only your own memories count. Conflict objectives require participation in the current conflict, not earlier battles. After each action or automatic effect, reveal a fulfilled Subplot, choose a character OR its alternative reward, discard it, and draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one Subplot per player may complete in each player turn, including automatic completion effects. Setup never completes Subplots. A replacement waits until a later turn before it can complete. Existing arrangements count; removing pieces can undo an unfinished objective. Twists and Subplots share your hand limit; at the end of your turn you may discard either. An unfinished Subplot discarded for hand limit gives no reward or replacement. Reshuffle discards as needed; played conflict Twists remain aside until scoring.

IMMEDIATE CONFLICT

Finish placement rewards, then immediately fight when the last numbered space gains an Inking, interrupting further placements. Agamemnon triggers with 1 space still empty; that empty space grants no check. All players with Inklings or figures here participate; lock them in. Reveal the Horse; resolve book/character start effects. Check numbered spaces ONCE, left to right. At each, its CURRENT Inking owner may play 1 Twist or pass. Skip empty or memory-only spaces; overflow grants no checks. Each owned space is a separate opportunity. Agamemnon/Strategists allow 1 extra Twist at ONE owned check per conflict, not cumulatively. Later spaces use their current occupants; earlier spaces never repeat. Finish even if erasures or upgrades empty spaces. Other full books wait until this conflict finishes.

SCORING AND REWARDS

After checks, total Inklings (1 each), character power, protagonist Valor and effects. Most power wins; ties favor the earliest participant clockwise from the active player. Discard all played Twists. Resolve win/loss and book after-effects, then clear Inklings according to the book: normally erase them; The Aeneid suspends them; Frankenstein erases old overflow and moves numbered-space Inklings into overflow, where they survive. Memories and figures stay. EVERY conflict takes 1 available current-Act token. Only an uncovered +3 space scores 3 times the NEW token's multiplier (x1/x2/x3); then cover it. A covered book gives NO printed book points. Gain every token's face-up reward in your chosen order: strong bonus or weak 1/2/3 points, never multiplied; flip them weak. The winner then draws and publishes a book touching at least 2 others and places 1 supply Inking in a touching old book's overflow. No books left: skip publication and its bonus.

ACTS AND VICTORY

The last available token ends the Act: finish that conflict, rewards and publication, then end the turn. No conflict resolves without an available token. With no supply at turn START, gain each unused token's strong bonus without book points, multipliers or publication; then end the Act. After Act III, highest points wins; ties share victory. Otherwise flip old tokens strong, uncover each +3 space, return character-card Inklings to supply, release the next reserve, prepare the Horse and display the next Act's selected tokens. Book Inklings stay. Next player starts. Any waiting full book resolves before normal movement.

BOOK EFFECTS

Dracula: mark the first numbered space with a castle. Its Inking owner may erase any one Inking here before Twist checks, including their own or overflow. The Odyssey rewards the moving figure's owner each time it crosses from this book to another, including ability moves; moving between its two pages gives nothing. Around the World lets the placing player choose their protagonist or any owned character to move one page. Placement effects resolve before checking for a full book. Moving existing Inklings grants no placement rewards. Jekyll may reduce points below zero. The submarine suspends all Inklings sent to overflow, including transfers and Nemo activation Inklings.

Current icon legend

Resources and memory rows use symbols. Actions and locations stay in words. Memories have a player-colored border, a large row symbol and a small reward reminder.



Inkling

Your limited supply of Inklings. Each Inkling on a book contributes 1 power.



Curiosity

Movement row. Memory reward:  place 1 Inkling into overflow on this book.



Protagonist

Your quill and inkwell figure. Its power comes from Valor.



Valor

Protagonist power row. Memory reward: gain 1 plot point.



Character

Draw the top character card when you gain one.



Insight

Hand-limit row. Memory reward: draw 1 Twist.



Twist

Play during your Inkling space check in conflict. On a book space: draw 1 Twist when placing an Inkling.



Resolve

Placement row. Memory reward: foreshadow 1 Inkling.



Plot points

Your score. The most plot points wins.



During conflict

A passive combat ability; no activation Inklings required.



Foreshadow Inklings

Take Inklings from your next Act reserve into your current supply.



Other passive

Use the printed timing; no activation Inklings required.



Activation square

Put one of your supply Inklings here to use the adjacent character action. Each square can hold one Inkling.



Memory hexagon

A memory improves its board row and stays on a book space. It adds no power and does not fill the space.

Erase = return to current supply. **Suspend** = send to next Act reserve.
Overflow = extra Inklings on a book, outside numbered spaces. It adds power but never fills a space.

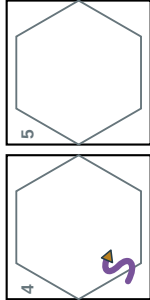
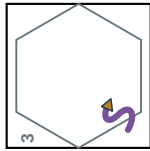
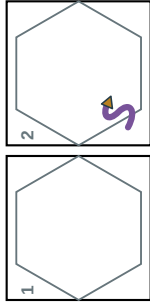
Journey to the Center of the Earth
The Underground Sea

VOYAGES

CONFLICT
+3

 DURING CONFLICT

Each Inkling in overflow here contributes +1 power (2 total).



OVERFLOW

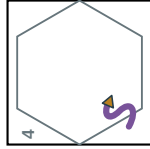
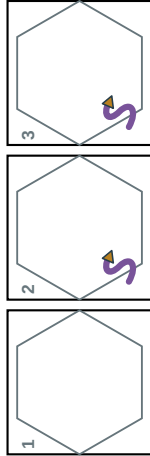
The Odyssey
The Journey

EPICS

CONFLICT
+3

 PASSIVE

Whenever your protagonist or a character moves from this book to another book, gain 1



OVERFLOW

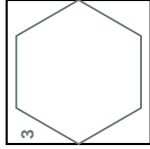
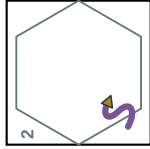
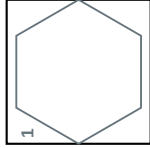
20,000 Leagues Under the Sea
In the Submarine

VOYAGES

CONFLICT
+3

 ON OVERFLOW

When an Inkling would enter overflow here, suspend it instead.



NO OVERFLOW / incoming overflow Inklings are erased

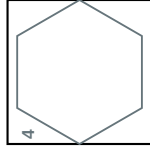
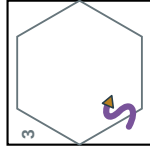
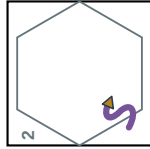
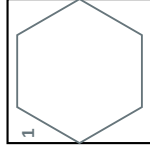
Around the World in 80 Days
The Railway Station

VOYAGES

CONFLICT
+3

 ON PLACEMENT

When you place an Inkling here, you may move your protagonist or one of your characters up to 1 page.



OVERFLOW

Dracula Castle Dracula		CONFLICT +3		✕ BEFORE CONFLICT The owner of the Inking in the castle space may erase any 1 Inking from this book.		1 2 3 4		OVERFLOW		1 2 3 4		✕ DURING CONFLICT Each character and protagonist here has +1 power.		CONFLICT +3		EPICS	
The Iliad Troy		CONFLICT +3		✕ AFTER CONFLICT Erase existing overflow Inklings, then move all Inklings in numbered spaces into overflow. These moved Inklings remain here.		1 2 3 4		OVERFLOW		1 2 3 4		✕ AFTER CONFLICT Suspend all Inklings here instead of erasing them during conflict cleanup.		CONFLICT +3		EPICS	
Frankenstein The Laboratory		CONFLICT +3		✕ AFTER CONFLICT Suspend all Inklings here instead of erasing them during conflict cleanup.		1 2 3 4		OVERFLOW		1 2 3 4		✕ AFTER CONFLICT Suspend all Inklings here instead of erasing them during conflict cleanup.		CONFLICT +3		EPICS	
The Aeneid The Shores of Latium		CONFLICT +3		✕ AFTER CONFLICT Suspend all Inklings here instead of erasing them during conflict cleanup.		1 2 3 4		OVERFLOW		1 2 3 4		✕ AFTER CONFLICT Suspend all Inklings here instead of erasing them during conflict cleanup.		CONFLICT +3		EPICS	

Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde

The London Street

ON PLACEMENT

When you place an Inking here, flip a coin. Heads: gain 1 🍀. Tails: lose 1 🍀

CONFLICT

+3 🍀

1

2

3

OVERFLOW

GOthic HORROR

CONFLICT

+3 🍀

1

2

3

OVERFLOW

TWIST A Hero Provoked CONFLICT Gain +3 power, plus +3 if you have a character here. <i>"Sing, O goddess, the anger of Achilles"</i> The Iliad 01	TWIST Doom Defied CONFLICT Gain +5 power. <i>"Fares Wyrd as she must."</i> Beowulf 02	TWIST Travelling Light CONFLICT Gain +6 power if you have exactly 1 Inkling here; otherwise gain +2 power. <i>"A well-used minimum suffices for everything."</i> Around the World in Eighty Days 03
TWIST Engines of Discovery CONFLICT Gain +2 power. Move up to 2 of your Inklings from other books into overflow here. <i>"This agent is electricity."</i> Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea 04	TWIST The Nameless Stratagem CONFLICT Gain +2 power. One opposing character contributes no power in this conflict. Its abilities still work. <i>"my name is Noman"</i> The Odyssey 05	TWIST A Costly Experiment CONFLICT Gain +2 power. You may erase up to 2 of your Inklings here; gain +3 power for each erased. <i>"We learn from failure, not from success!"</i> Dracula 06
TWIST The Outcast's Revenge CONFLICT Gain +3 power. If you lose, erase 1 opposing Inkling on another book. <i>"Beware, for I am fearless and therefore powerful."</i> Frankenstein 07	TWIST A Lasting Legend CONFLICT Gain +3 power. If you win, gain 2 extra 🌟 <i>"glory ere death!"</i> Beowulf 08	TWIST Mathematical Leap CONFLICT Gain +2 power. Move your protagonist to either page of this book. <i>"Quite possible, on the contrary"</i> Around the World in Eighty Days 09

TWIST An Ocean Without Borders CONFLICT Move up to 3 of your Inklings from other books into overflow here. <i>"The sea is everything."</i> Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea 10	TWIST Crossing the Threshold CONFLICT Foreshadow 2 Inklings. Then place up to 2 supply Inklings into overflow here. <i>"Our real journey had now commenced."</i> Journey to the Center of the Earth 11	TWIST Divine Favor CONFLICT Gain +3 power. Make 1 extra upgrade at this book by suspending 1 of your Inklings. <i>"in the hands of the immortal gods"</i> The Iliad 12
TWIST An Unlikely Champion CONFLICT Return 1 of your memories from this book to draw a character onto the page being checked. <i>"Tell me, O Muse, of that ingenious hero"</i> The Odyssey 13	TWIST Stolen Vitality CONFLICT Erase 1 opposing Inkling here. Then place 1 of yours in its old space, gaining any placement rewards. <i>"The blood is the life!"</i> Dracula 14	TWIST A Hero Returns CONFLICT Gain +3 power. Erase up to 2 of your activation Inklings from character cards. <i>"Be of good courage"</i> The Odyssey 15
SUBPLOT The Unfinished Map HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Have your memories on 3 different books, with your protagonist on one of those books. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Foreshadow 2 Inklings. Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 16	SUBPLOT A Name in Every Song HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Have at least 1 upgrade in each of 3 different tracks. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Gain 4  Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 17	SUBPLOT Traveling Companions HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Have 2 of your memories on different pages of the same book, and your protagonist or one of your characters on that book. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Erase up to 3 of your activation Inklings from character cards. Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 18

SUBPLOT The Gathering HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Have 2 of your memories of different types on the same page, with your protagonist on that page. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Place up to 2 Inklings into overflow at your protagonist's book. Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 19	SUBPLOT Beyond the Horizon HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Have Resolve at level 2 or higher and Curiosity at level 1 or higher. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Draw 2 Twists. Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 20	SUBPLOT The Shared Story HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Have 2 of your memories on the same book, with another player's Inking occupying at least one of them. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Gain 4  Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 21
SUBPLOT A Tale Worth Telling HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Participate in a conflict on a book with one of your Insight memories, while your Insight track is level 2 or higher. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Foreshadow 2 Inklings. Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 22	SUBPLOT Into the Fray HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Participate in a conflict on your protagonist's book with one of your Valor memories there. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Gain 4  Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 23	SUBPLOT The Empty House HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Have your memories in both the first and last numbered spaces of the same book. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Draw 2 Twists. Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 24
SUBPLOT A Second Chance HIDDEN OBJECTIVE Have your Inking on one of your memories and a second, different type of your memory on the same book. WHEN FULFILLED, CHOOSE ONE Draw 1  OR Make 1 extra upgrade on your protagonist's page by suspending 1 of your Inklings there. Reveal, resolve, discard, then draw a new hidden Subplot. At most one completion per player turn. 25	CHARACTER POWER 1 Dracula GOTHIC HORROR Move Dracula up to 1 page. You may erase 1 opposing Inking here, then place 1 of yours in its old space and gain its memory reward. 26	CHARACTER POWER 0 Frankenstein GOTHIC HORROR COLLECT YOUR ERASED Inklings ∞ When one of your Inklings is erased from a book, you may put it in an empty collection space here instead. At 3 Inklings, Frankenstein has 5 power and may move 1 page at the end of your turn. 27

CHARACTERPOWER 1 Jekyll GOthic HORROR Flip a coin. Heads: move Jekyll up to 1 page, then place up to 2 Inklings into overflow here. Tails: erase 1 opposing Inking here. 28	CHARACTERPOWER 3 Achilles EPICS Move Achilles up to 1 page. Erase 1 opposing Inking on Achilles' page. 29	CHARACTERPOWER 0 Trojan Horse EPICS Move the Trojan Horse up to 2 pages. ✗ When gained and at each Act start, hide 1 of its 5 power cards here. Reveal it at this book's next conflict; it lasts for that conflict, then stays spent until the next Act. 30
CHARACTERPOWER 1 Agamemnon EPICS Move Agamemnon up to 2 pages. ✗ Exception: trigger conflict with 1 empty Inking space here. Agamemnon fills no slot and grants no space check. Once per conflict, play 2 Twists at one of your Inking checks instead of 1. 31	CHARACTERPOWER 2 Odysseus EPICS Move Odysseus up to 3 pages. ✗ Whenever you play a Twist in a conflict here, draw 1 Twist. 32	CHARACTERPOWER 1 Captain Nemo VOYAGES Move Nemo to any page. ✗ Before Twists are played, you may move any activation Inklings from this card into overflow at Nemo's book. This empties those activation spaces. 33
CHARACTERPOWER 1 Phileas Fogg VOYAGES Move Fogg to any page. Then you may move your protagonist to any page. 34	CHARACTERPOWER 2 Ichthyosaur VOYAGES Put Ichthyosaur between any 2 edge-adjacent pages on different books. ∞ Ichthyosaur is present on both adjoining pages and contributes power in either book's conflict. 35	HORSE POWER Secret Army TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER ✗ Before Twists, place up to 3 Inklings from your supply into overflow here. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 36

HORSE POWER Strategists TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER ✖ Once this conflict, play 2 Twists at one of your Inkling space checks instead of 1. Does not stack with Agamemnon. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 37	HORSE POWER Tribute to the Gods TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER ✖ If you win this conflict, gain 4 extra 🌟 Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 38	HORSE POWER All Part of the Plan TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER ✖ If you win this conflict, complete your current Subplot, regardless of its conditions (at most one Subplot completion per player per turn). Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 39
HORSE POWER I Know Your Weakness TROJAN HORSE / HIDDEN POWER ✖ Ignore all other characters' power and abilities at this book for this conflict. Effects already resolved are not undone. Reveal at its book's next conflict. One use this Act. 40		



Cover each row with 3 matching memories. Uncover left to right.



CURIOSITY

Move 1 page



Move 2 pages



Move 3 pages



Move 4 pages

MEMORIES

Place one Inking into overflow.



VALOR

Protagonist power 0



Power 1



Power 2



Power 3

MEMORIES

Gain 1 ✨



INSIGHT

Combined hand limit 3



Combined limit 4



Combined limit 5



Combined limit 6

MEMORIES

Draw 1 Twist.



RESOLVE

Place 1 Inking



Discard 1 Twist to place 2, or place 1 free



Place up to 2 Inkings



Place up to 3 Inkings

MEMORIES

Foreshadow 1 Inking.

ACT II RESERVE

3 starting Inkings + suspended Inkings

ACT III RESERVE

3 starting Inkings + suspended Inkings



Cover each row with 3 matching memories. Uncover left to right.



CURIOSITY

Move 1 page



Move 2 pages



Move 3 pages



Move 4 pages

MEMORIES

Place one Inking into overflow.



VALOR

Protagonist power 0



Power 1



Power 2



Power 3

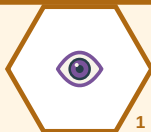
MEMORIES

Gain 1 ✨

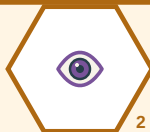


INSIGHT

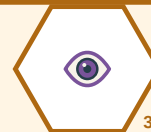
Combined hand limit 3



Combined limit 4



Combined limit 5



Combined limit 6

MEMORIES

Draw 1 Twist.



RESOLVE

Place 1 Inking



Discard 1 Twist to place 2, or place 1 free



Place up to 2 Inkings



Place up to 3 Inkings

MEMORIES

Foreshadow 1 Inking.

ACT II RESERVE

3 starting Inkings + suspended Inkings

ACT III RESERVE

3 starting Inkings + suspended Inkings

Plot points



0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
39	38	37	36	35	34	33	32	31	30	29	28	27	26	25	24	23	22	21	20
40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59
79	78	77	76	75	74	73	72	71	70	69	68	67	66	65	64	63	62	61	60
80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99

ACT

I

II

III

AVAILABLE TOKENS / CURRENT ACT

Every conflict takes 1 token from this pool. Its last token ends the Act.

CONFLICT REWARDS

Uncovered book: +3 ★ times the new token's multiplier.
Covered book: no printed book points.
Gain the new bonus and each older token's face-up reward; flip all to their backs.

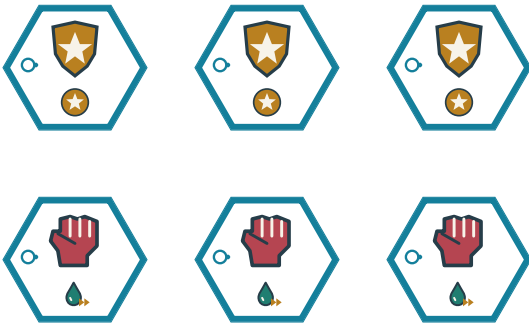
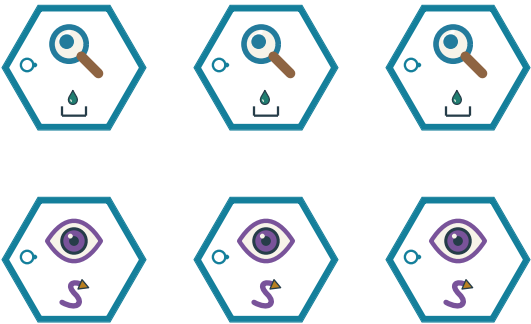
END OF ACT

Last token used, or a player starts with no Inklings.
Flip book tokens strong; uncover book VP spaces.
Erase character-card Inklings; release the next reserve.
Prepare Trojan Horse and the next Act's token pool.

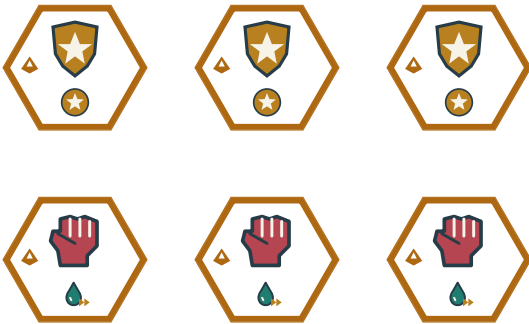
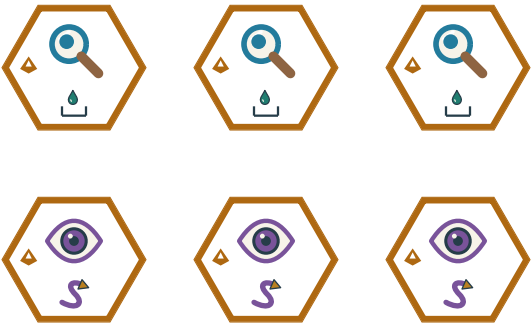
Memories

12 per player / 3 per row

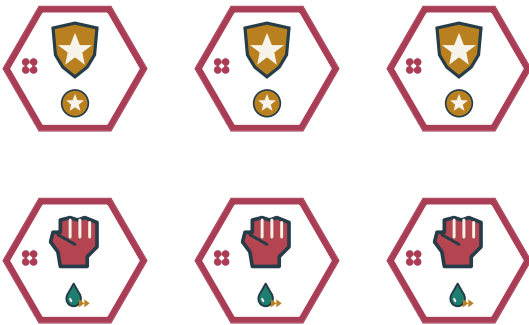
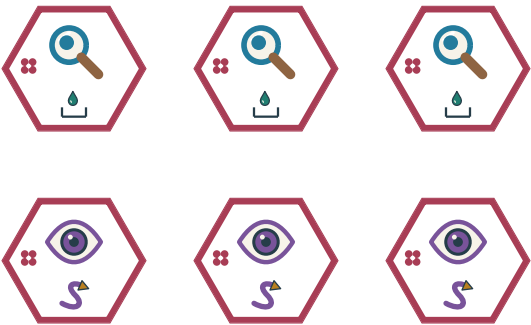
 Teal / orbit



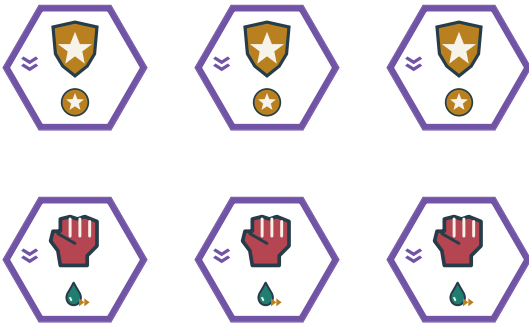
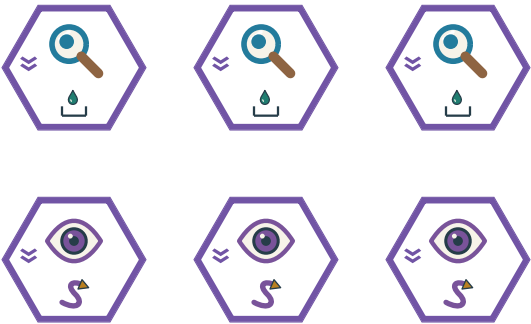
 Amber / prism



 Rose / petals



 Violet / chevrons



ACT I	ACT I	ACT I	ACT I	ACT I
A New Chapter Draw 1 character.	Fresh Inklings Foreshadow 2 Inklings.	Revision Make 1 extra upgrade at any book.	Inspiration Draw 2  . Foreshadow 1 Inkling.	Second Wind Erase up to 2 activation  . Draw 1 
x1	x1	x1	x1	x1
ACT II	ACT II	ACT II	ACT II	ACT II
A Rising Star Draw 1 character. Gain 2 	New Possibilities Make 1 extra upgrade at any book. Draw 2 	A Wider World Foreshadow 2 Inklings. Gain 2 	Renewed Purpose Erase up to 3 activation  . Gain 2 	A Bold Turn Draw 2  . Gain 3 
x2	x2	x2	x2	x2
ACT III	ACT III	ACT III	ACT III	ACT III
A Lasting Legacy Gain 6 	The Final Twist Draw 2  . Gain 4 	A Hero's Farewell Gain 4  . Erase up to 2 activation 	The Final Revision Make 1 extra upgrade at any book. Gain 4 	An Encore Draw 1 character. Gain 4 
x3	x3	x3	x3	x3

ACT I 1 	ACT I 1 	ACT I 1 	ACT I 1 	ACT I 1 
ACT II 2 	ACT II 2 	ACT II 2 	ACT II 2 	ACT II 2 
ACT III 3 	ACT III 3 	ACT III 3 	ACT III 3 	ACT III 3 